

Even so far from home, Medea's skills as a witch were well-known, and she used this to her advantage. She went to Pelias's daughters. "I can teach you a spell to make your father young again," she promised.

"How?" the girls asked eagerly.

"It's very simple. You must cut your father into tiny pieces and boil them in water," Medea replied.

The princesses were unsure at first, but Medea demonstrated her spell by cutting up a ram and turning it into a lamb.

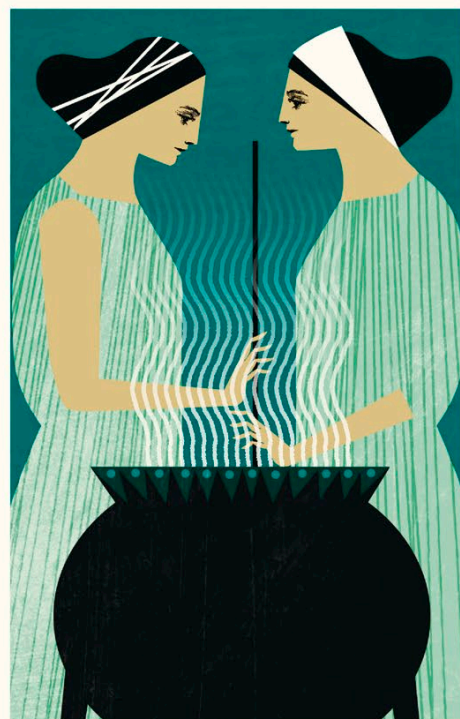
*Now, they were convinced.*

Pelias's daughters were not witches, however, and when they attempted Medea's spell their father did not come back to life as the lamb had done.

With Pelias dead, his son Acastos succeeded him on the throne. His first decision as king was to banish Jason and Medea from the kingdom, so the couple traveled to Corinth, where they had two sons.

*Still, as the years went by, Jason dreamed of returning to Iolcus.*

Then Jason learned that one of the other Argonauts, Peleus, was planning to attack Acastos. Jason rushed to join him in the fight. Acastos was easily defeated, and for his help, Jason became ruler of Iolcus. The prophecy that his uncle, Pelias, had feared had finally come true.



*The girls boiled up the pieces of King Pelias in a cauldron.*

